



Changing guard: Harry Brook has taken over as England's white-ball captain, replacing Jos Buttler, who stepped down after England's early exit from the Champions Trophy in February last year. AP

Heavyweights and hidden traps



OUR DISCUSSION ON
BANGLADESH'S
BOYCOTT

Two former champions headline Group C, but preparation gaps and fearless underdogs threaten to turn a routine qualification into a **survival test.**

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Bangladesh's unceremonious, eleventh-hour withdrawal from this T20 World Cup paved the way for Scotland's entry into Group C. But the European side is not the only one to have benefited from the last-minute change.

Bangladesh's presence might have made for a closer qualification race. Now, however, West Indies and England are the overwhelming favourites in a group that also comprises Nepal and debutant Italy. England's 4-1 drubbing at the hands of India last January forced the side to rejig its leadership. Harry Brook has taken over as captain from Jos Buttler, ushering in a new, high-octane approach for the 2022

champion.

In September last year, England posted 304 against South Africa, the highest T20I total by a Full Member, courtesy of Phil Salt's belligerent 40-ball 161. With a strike rate in excess of 172 and an average of 43, Salt has played the disruptor up top for England in this cycle. Liberated from the weight of leadership, Buttler has been given a free hand too.

Under Brook's charge since April